

Sophia Ruger

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OBJECTIVE

Purpose-driven professional with a background in sustainability, GIS, and applied research, committed to using data and technology to improve communities, support environmental stewardship, and advance meaningful public service.

COMPETENCIES & TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Data Analysis:** Cartographic Visualization, Data Cleaning, Statistical Methods, Programming.
- **Project Management:** Communication, Presentations (Adobe, Powerpoint), Organization, and Leadership.
- **Research:** Social and Behavioral (IRB certified), annotated bibliographies (Zotero), and active reading.
- **Software:** ArcGIS Pro (Geographic Information System), Python, R Studio, Microsoft Office Suite, Google Drive.
- **Communication:** Excellent written and verbal skills, report preparation, presentation and collaboration with private and public entities.
- **Public Engagement:** Engaging diverse communities, large meetings and public events.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Director of Sustainability, Martin Hammond, Undergraduate Student Government **July 2025 – May 2026**

- Developed legislation to reduce waste and improve student life on Arizona State University's (ASU) Tempe campus.
- Organized events for student groups, including the Student Made event which generated \$365 per hour in profit for student entrepreneurs.
- Collaborated with student and faculty organizations to relaunch the ASU Sustainability Summit.

Geographic Information System (GIS) Intern, Connor Sheehan, Christina Ngo, Social Embeddedness **April 2025 – May 2026**

- Analyzed 5,000 intake points at over 30 women's shelter locations throughout the State of Arizona.
- Cleaned and managed Maricopa County Animal Control's activity and licensing data, including over 200,000 data points.
- Completed four presentations and facilitated collaborative communications with community partners.
- Co-hosted geospatial dashboard workshops for over 30 employees of four food banks throughout the State of Arizona.

Intern, Garden Habitats of Arizona, Kelli Larson, CAP REU at ASU **May 2024 – Sept 2025**

- Geolocated over 4,300 data entries, analyzed trends and anomalies over specific time period.
- Collaborated with the Arizona Wildlife Federation to author a blog series ([AWF](#)).
- Created three poster displays, highlighting important work and engaging viewers in professional presentations.

Hostess and Server, Social Hall Tempe **July 2024 – Dec 2024**

- Welcomed over 100 guests per shift, attended to phone orders and provided attentive table service to dining room guests.

Research Assistant, Human-Wildlife Coexistence, Kelli Larson, SURE at ASU **Jan 2024 – May 2024**

- Conducted a literature review of urban coyote research using Zotero.
- Presented social science solutions and analysis at the Central Arizona-Phoenix, Long Term Ecological Research Symposia.

Eco Representative, Paige Strickland, ASU **Sept 2023 – April 2024**

- Educated over 1,000 students about sustainable practices; planned, promoted, and co-hosted 20 events.
- Manage social media and create engaging science communication material using Adobe and Canva.

Server and Line Cook, Deno's Pizzeria, Lake Oswego, OR **May 2023 – Aug 2023**

- Provided food and beverage service to over 50 customers per shift, attended to phone customer and dining room service.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Treasurer, WakeDevils Club, ASU Athletics **Oct 2022 – Present**

- Raised over \$5,000 in funds for annual competition, managed team finances, and recruited new members.

Member, Campus Student Sustainability Initiatives at ASU **Nov 2022 – Nov 2024**

- Organize "Really Really Free Market" initiative, provided living necessities to the Tempe, AZ community residents.

Teaching Assistant, Patrick Connolly, Lakeridge High School **May 2021 – June 2021**

- Developed education material for a sustainable agriculture unit for Ecology and Conservation class.

EDUCATION

Sustainability BS, Arizona State University, Tempe, Arizona

Graduating May 2026, *Summa Cum Laude*

Relevant coursework: Research Skills, Systems Thinking, Landscapes and Sustainability, Ecosystems

Geographic Information Science BS, Arizona State University, Tempe, Arizona

Graduating May 2026, *Summa Cum Laude*

Relevant Coursework: Programming II, GIS for Climate Change Science, GIS III

Urban Planning Minor, Arizona State University, Tempe, Arizona

Graduating May 2026, *Summa Cum Laude*

Relevant coursework: Transportation & Environmental Planning, Urban Design